THE WITNESS REMAINS

Who Is Barran Dodger? A Documented Life Inside Australia's Public Institutions

An evidence-led public-interest investigation into institutional accountability, the pursuit of remedies, disability, material hardship, whistleblowing and the preservation of a public record

Subject: Dr Richard William McLean, writing under the public identity Barran Dodger and Barran Resonance Dodger.

Principal evidentiary source: *Dear The CEO and Principal Registrar of the Federal Court, Sia Lagos, at email a.pdf*, read alongside the Official Government Documents Register and the public Barran Dodger archives.

Publication purpose: To make a complex personal and administrative history accessible to independent readers, journalists, researchers, legal practitioners, advocates and public institutions.

Editorial status: Documentary investigation and first-person account. This is not a court judgment, a finding of criminal liability, or an independent determination that every allegation is true.

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1. The question at the centre of this record

What happens when a person repeatedly reports serious harm, approaches institutions for assistance, disputes adverse decisions, preserves the correspondence and continues to ask for an explanation—but does not believe that the available processes have resolved the underlying problems?

The archive assembled by Dr Richard William McLean, publicly known as Barran Dodger, provides material through which that question can be examined.

It brings together correspondence, administrative decisions, insurance documents, complaints, tribunal material, personal testimony and a growing digital archive. The

records concern several areas of public and private administration, including disability support, workers' compensation, insurance, public-interest disclosures, police interactions, legal access, accommodation and personal safety.

The significance of such a record cannot be determined by accepting its author's conclusions in advance. Nor can it be determined by dismissing his account because it is lengthy, emotionally charged, unconventional or difficult to navigate.

The appropriate task is to examine the documents.

What did McLean report? When did he report it? What material did he provide? Which institution responded? What did that institution actually decide? Was the decision about the substance of the allegation, the jurisdiction of the organisation, eligibility, evidence, procedure or something else? What consequences followed? Which questions remain unresolved?

These are the questions that make this archive potentially significant to the public interest.

The distinction is fundamental: a documented complaint is evidence that a concern was raised; it is not automatically proof that the alleged conduct occurred. An administrative refusal is evidence of a decision; it does not automatically establish that the decision was correct or incorrect. A sequence of adverse outcomes may justify investigation without, by itself, proving coordination or unlawful intent.

The record deserves to be assessed according to those principles.

2. Who is Barran Dodger?

Barran Dodger is the public identity used by Dr Richard William McLean in a documentary, autobiographical, advocacy and faith-based project. His published material describes a life involving scholarship, journalism, artistic work, wellness advocacy, disability-related experiences, institutional complaints and religious writing.

His archive is both a personal testimony and an attempt to organise a large body of documentary material into a form that others can inspect.

McLean's account describes a profound loss of security, income, possessions, access to assistance and confidence in institutions. He alleges that multiple decisions and omissions contributed to his deterioration and that his attempts to seek protection and redress did not produce an adequate resolution.

Those are serious claims. Their seriousness is a reason to identify their evidentiary basis carefully—not to treat them as proven merely because they are repeated, and not to disregard them merely because they originate in personal testimony.

The archive contains different kinds of material that must be distinguished:

- **Primary records: correspondence, determinations, official letters, tribunal decisions, insurance communications and other documents created by the organisations or people involved.**
- **First-person testimony: McLean's accounts of events, his understanding of their causes and his descriptions of their consequences.**
- **Administrative outcomes: decisions about eligibility, jurisdiction, allocation, compensation, complaints or further action.**
- **Documentary analysis: attempts to connect events, compare accounts, establish chronology and identify recurring institutional obstacles.**
- **Interpretation and belief: McLean's conclusions about the meaning of his experiences, including his moral, political and religious interpretations.**

These categories can inform one another, but they are not interchangeable.

The first-person account establishes what McLean says he experienced and believed. An official letter can establish what its author communicated. A tribunal decision can establish the outcome and reasoning of the matter actually decided. A broader conclusion about institutional responsibility requires examination of the relevant evidence and applicable standards.

That is the method this article applies.

3. The central source: the letter of 3 March 2023

One of the most important documents in the supplied compilation is a letter dated 3 March 2023, addressed to the CEO and Principal Registrar of the Federal Court of Australia, Sia Lagos.

The document identifies the sender as Dr Richard McLean and records that he had no fixed address at the time.

The letter is important because it brings several strands of his account together in a communication directed to a senior court official. It describes alleged family violence and financial coercive control, a police and hospital episode, the reported loss of possessions while he was in hospital, homelessness, disability-related barriers,

insurance disputes and an attempt to invoke the Commonwealth public-interest disclosure framework.

It is not merely a retrospective narrative. It is also a record of what McLean was asking a public institution to consider at that point in time.

3.1 What the letter reports

In the letter, McLean says he had publicly protested what he described as prolonged victimisation and financial coercive control in a video posted on 4 August 2022. He reports that, after publishing it, police entered his home, that he was taken to hospital, and that his possessions were subsequently removed or destroyed while he was there.

He identifies Footscray Police, Werribee Mercy Hospital and Saltwater Clinic, including a person named Kade Mollison, in his account of the events.

He also states that he had identified himself to government authorities as being at risk, yet believed further harm followed without adequate intervention.

These statements identify allegations requiring careful examination. The letter alone does not independently establish who removed the possessions, who authorised any action, what happened to the property, whether all the named parties were involved, or whether any conduct was unlawful.

The evidentiary questions are concrete:

1. **What records exist of the police attendance and the reason for it?**
2. **What do the hospital records establish about the admission, the patient's condition and the timing of events?**
3. **Is there an inventory, removal record, disposal record, tenancy record or witness account concerning the possessions?**
4. **What communications show that McLean had reported a risk before the events?**
5. **Which agency received those communications, and what response did it make?**
6. **What evidence establishes the circumstances of his subsequent accommodation or homelessness?**

The public value of the archive lies partly in making it possible to pursue those questions against the actual records rather than relying solely on either the author's account or an institution's summary.

3.2 The reported injury and its consequences

The compilation contains McLean's description of a suicide attempt that he says was deemed "fatal", that he survived after being found unresponsive, and that he experienced cognitive impairment afterwards.

The letter apologises for its disorganisation and attributes that difficulty to the impairment he reports.

This material has two distinct evidentiary dimensions.

First, medical records could establish the clinical circumstances, diagnosis, treatment, prognosis and any recorded cognitive effects of the incident. Second, the letter establishes that McLean was describing those experiences to the recipient and presenting them as relevant to his ability to communicate and pursue assistance.

The wording used in the letter should not be substituted for a medical finding unless the underlying clinical record supports it. Nor should a reported cognitive impairment be used to dismiss the contents of the letter without examining the substantive material.

A fair review would consider both the reliability and context of the account, the underlying medical evidence, and whether the communication raised issues requiring an appropriate response.

3.3 The question of possessions and material loss

McLean states that his possessions were taken to a tip while he was in hospital and that he was subsequently rejected by a homelessness shelter with only a bag of clothes.

If corroborated, these circumstances would be relevant to housing security, property rights, disability-related vulnerability and the practical ability to pursue legal or administrative remedies.

But the necessary distinction remains: the letter records McLean's allegation; it is not itself an independent finding about the identity, authority, purpose or legality of the people involved.

The investigation should therefore trace any available property, police, hospital, housing and witness records. The article should not convert the allegation into a concluded finding before those records are examined.

3.4 Why the addressee matters

Addressing the letter to the CEO and Principal Registrar of the Federal Court is relevant to its documentary history. It establishes that McLean directed this communication to a senior official of that institution.

It does not, by itself, establish that the Federal Court had jurisdiction over every matter described, that the court was responsible for the alleged events, or that the court accepted the allegations.

Those questions depend on the nature of the correspondence, the statutory framework, the responses made and the scope of any assessment.

The letter is therefore best treated as a key entry in a chronology of attempted disclosure and redress—not as proof that the addressee or the institution was responsible for all the matters it described.

4. The public-interest disclosure question

A major theme in the compilation is McLean's effort to have his communications treated as public-interest disclosures under the *Public Interest Disclosure Act 2013* (Cth).

The distinction between an allegation of wrongdoing and a disclosure that meets the applicable statutory requirements is important. A person may report serious conduct yet encounter questions about the recipient's authority, the identity or status of the discloser, the nature of the alleged conduct, or the institution's jurisdiction.

Those procedural questions can determine whether a disclosure is allocated for investigation, referred elsewhere or not dealt with under the statutory scheme.

4.1 The Federal Court assessment of 27 March 2023

The Official Government Documents Register identifies a Federal Court PID assessment dated 27 March 2023, associated with General Counsel Scott Tredwell.

The assessment records three categories of conduct that McLean believed his information tended to show:

- **conduct perverting or attempting to pervert the course of justice;**
- **maladministration; and**
- **conduct unreasonably causing, or increasing the risk of, harm to health or safety.**

The assessment contains the following significant wording:

> **"It is difficult to determine whether this belief is based on reasonable grounds or not. However, for the purposes of the initial assessment I am prepared to assume that the conduct disclosed in your correspondence and other information received is disclosable conduct for the purposes of the PID Act."**

This passage is important because it describes an initial assessment in which the decision-maker was prepared to assume, for that assessment, that the alleged conduct fell within the category of disclosable conduct.

It must not be represented as a finding that the alleged conduct was proven, that a criminal offence occurred, or that the assessment endorsed every factual assertion made by McLean.

The assessment also records that the conduct described did not relate to the Federal Court, the Federal Circuit and Family Court of Australia or the National Native Title Tribunal, and states that those court bodies or another Commonwealth agency would not take further action under the PID Act on the correspondence and information received.

The register records the decision not to allocate the disclosure, including concerns about whether it had been made by a public official or given to an authorised recipient.

This is a significant procedural distinction. The question of whether a disclosure can be handled under a statutory framework is not identical to the question of whether the underlying allegations are true.

The assessment does not prove or disprove the alleged wrongdoing. It documents how the disclosure was considered and why it did not proceed through that particular route.

4.2 What this assessment establishes—and what it does not

The record supports the following limited conclusions:

1. **A public-interest disclosure assessment was undertaken.**
2. **The assessment identified the types of alleged conduct raised by McLean.**
3. **The assessor expressly distinguished an initial assumption about the character of the alleged conduct from a conclusion about its truth.**
4. **The assessment identified jurisdictional and procedural reasons why the correspondence would not be pursued under that process.**
5. **The record documents an administrative outcome, rather than a judicial**

determination of the underlying allegations.

It would be inaccurate to describe this document as a court judgment confirming that McLean was a protected whistleblower. It would also be inaccurate to treat the decision not to allocate the disclosure as a finding that the alleged conduct never occurred.

The document's significance is more precise: it provides an official record of a disclosure assessment, the limits of the assessment and the reasons the process did not advance.

4.3 The broader public-interest question

The issue for independent review is whether the available disclosure and complaint pathways were appropriate to the matters raised, whether communications reached the correct recipients, whether referrals or alternative routes were available, and whether the relevant decisions were adequately explained.

The answer cannot be supplied by treating all refusals as proof of a cover-up, nor by treating every refusal as proof that the complaint lacked merit.

It requires the correspondence, applicable procedures, decision reasons and any later referrals to be read together.

5. The wider chronology: decisions, complaints and unresolved remedies

The archive's official register identifies a sequence of records across different institutions and years. Among the entries identified are the following.

2021 — compensation and disability-related administration

OGDR-007 — Comcare determination, claim 1326583/1, dated 26 May 2021.

This record concerns a compensation determination. Its relevance is that it provides an identifiable administrative decision against which the underlying claim, reasons and any subsequent review can be assessed.

The determination should be read in its own terms. It cannot be used to establish facts beyond the issues it decided.

The wider compilation also includes NDIA-related correspondence, including a plan-review outcome dated 15 December 2021. These records are relevant to the separate

question of disability support and the administrative decisions affecting McLean's circumstances.

2022 — integrity complaints and disclosure processes

OGDR-027 — IBAC assessment outcome, dated 12 April 2022.

This register entry records an outcome from the Independent Broad-based Anti-corruption Commission. Its evidentiary significance depends on the full outcome letter: what was referred, what was assessed, the jurisdiction applied and what reasons were given.

OGDR-030 — Commonwealth Ombudsman decision not to allocate a disclosure, dated 16 September 2022.

This is another important entry in the disclosure chronology. A decision not to allocate a matter is an administrative outcome. To understand its significance, a reader must distinguish the reasons for non-allocation from any substantive investigation or determination of the allegations.

The 3 March 2023 letter refers back to earlier events, including McLean's 4 August 2022 video and his account of subsequent harm. The letter therefore connects the later disclosure attempt to an earlier period of reported risk and complaint-making.

The chronology should preserve the original dates and documents rather than compressing them into an unsupported assertion that all events had a single cause.

2023 — disclosure assessment and compensation review

OGDR-036 — Federal Court PID assessment, dated 27 March 2023.

This is the disclosure assessment discussed above. It is central because it documents the treatment of McLean's public-interest disclosure correspondence.

OGDR-070 — *Re Richard McLean and Comcare*, AAT decision, dated 12 July 2023.

The register records that the Administrative Appeals Tribunal affirmed Comcare's decision and held that, for the relevant Commonwealth compensation legislation, McLean was not a Commonwealth employee.

This is a substantive administrative-review outcome concerning a defined legal

question. It should not be misrepresented as a determination of every aspect of McLean's employment history, every injury allegation, or all possible avenues of compensation.

It is relevant to the wider story because legal classification and eligibility can determine access to a particular statutory remedy. The public-interest question is whether the reasons and consequences of that decision were properly understood and whether other applicable remedies were available.

2024 — complaints and freedom-of-information correspondence

The archive register and the wider compilation identify further correspondence, including an NSW Police complaint outcome dated 24 August 2024 and a revised decision concerning a PM&C freedom-of-information request dated 8 October 2024.

These documents should be examined separately. A police complaint outcome may concern whether a particular complaint was accepted, assessed or acted upon. An FOI decision concerns access to information under the relevant framework. Neither category should automatically be treated as a determination of all the factual allegations in McLean's broader account.

The value of the chronology is that it permits the reader to see what information was sought, which institution responded, what decision was made and what avenue—if any—was identified next.

2025 — disability support and accommodation

The register and related material identify an NDIA plan approval dated 20 November 2025 and an Anglicare safety assessment or duty-of-care document dated 1 December 2025.

These records are relevant to the practical conditions of safety, disability support and accommodation. Their significance depends on the actual content: the approved supports, any stated conditions, the assessment's findings, the responsibilities assigned and any identified risks.

The article does not assume that the existence of an approval or assessment proves that all needs were met, or that a gap in support necessarily proves misconduct. The documents should be compared with the support actually delivered, requests made and subsequent communications.

2026 — guardianship and accommodation

OGDR-077 — NCAT Guardianship Division cover letter, dated 18 March 2026, concerning reasons in case 2024/00324093.

This entry identifies a tribunal-related record that should be read in its full procedural context.

The archive also identifies an SIL/SDA accommodation request dated 20 January 2026 and emergency safety-assessment material from January 2026.

These records matter because secure accommodation, adequate support and personal safety are practical conditions of independent living. The investigation should establish what was requested, what was assessed, which decisions were made and what assistance was ultimately provided.

A chronology across these years reveals the range of administrative systems with which McLean says he interacted. It does not, without further evidence, prove that the systems acted together or shared an unlawful purpose.

6. The insurance dispute: a separate but consequential strand

The supplied PDF includes correspondence relating to HCF Life and a claim under an Income Assist policy.

The compilation reproduces a letter from Sheena Jack dated 7 June 2022 stating that a full investigation had been undertaken, that the insurer maintained its position that the claim had been correctly declined, and that it would no longer correspond about the matter.

The correspondence is important because it documents a specific disputed insurance outcome and the insurer's stated position.

McLean challenges that outcome and describes it as unfair. He also refers to potential income-protection and total-and-permanent-disability benefits, and to a substantial financial loss.

Those statements must be carefully separated:

- **The insurer's letter establishes the position it communicated.**
- **McLean's correspondence establishes that he disputed the decision and sought a**

different outcome.

- The policy documents and claim file are necessary to assess the contractual terms, medical evidence, reasons for refusal and review process.
- Any statement about a particular benefit amount must be supported by the applicable policy, eligibility conditions and actual claim evidence.

The compilation contains insurance-related material and historical superannuation documents. A document showing a policy, benefit table or investment statement does not itself prove that a particular claim was payable.

The public-interest question is whether the decision was made in accordance with the policy and applicable obligations, whether the evidence was fairly assessed and whether the review pathway was adequate.

The article should not state that an insurer deliberately deprived McLean of a specific sum unless the evidence establishes that conclusion.

7. The cumulative effect: when separate decisions become a public-interest question

The strongest broader argument in the archive is not that every institution necessarily acted with the same intention. It is that the consequences of multiple decisions and unresolved disputes may accumulate in the life of one person.

A compensation decision can affect income. An insurance dispute can affect financial security. A disability-support decision can affect access to practical assistance. A housing decision can affect personal safety and stability. A disclosure process can determine whether a complaint proceeds under a particular statutory scheme. Difficulty obtaining legal assistance can make it harder to challenge any of those outcomes.

These are different systems, with different powers and legal responsibilities. Their effects may nevertheless intersect in a person’s everyday life.

This is the basis for examining cumulative institutional attrition: the possibility that the combined consequences of administrative decisions, procedural barriers, financial insecurity, housing instability and unresolved complaints may progressively diminish a person’s practical capacity to exercise rights and live independently.

The concept is an analytical framework, not a finding of wrongdoing.

To test it, a reviewer would need to establish the actual sequence of events, the decision-making responsibility at each stage, the consequences that can be

demonstrated, the alternatives that were available, and any evidence of causation or coordination.

The archive's potential significance lies in bringing the records together so that this cumulative question can be asked and tested rather than left scattered across unrelated correspondence.

8. The difference between institutional failure and coordinated wrongdoing

McLean interprets his experiences as a pattern of persecution, exclusion and institutional failure. Some of his writings go further, alleging deliberate coordination and targeted conduct.

These interpretations are part of his testimony and explain the urgency and moral language of his publications. They should be represented accurately as his account.

However, a rigorous investigation must distinguish between at least four possibilities:

1. **A substantiated individual failure: a particular decision, action or omission is shown by the evidence to have been wrong.**
2. **A procedural or jurisdictional barrier: an institution does not act because a matter falls outside its powers or does not meet the requirements of a particular process.**
3. **A pattern of cumulative adverse outcomes: separate decisions have serious combined consequences, even where the evidence does not establish common intent.**
4. **Coordinated unlawful conduct: evidence establishes that multiple actors acted together, or pursuant to a shared purpose, in a manner that breached applicable law.**

The fourth proposition requires evidence of the relevant connections and conduct. The fact that several organisations dealt with a person, that several decisions were adverse, or that one agency did not investigate another agency's conduct does not, on its own, establish a conspiracy.

Conversely, the absence of a proven conspiracy does not make every individual decision fair, every administrative response adequate, or every allegation unworthy of investigation.

The correct approach is to test each proposition separately and then assess whether the cumulative record supports a broader conclusion.

9. Disability, vulnerability and access to justice

The documents describe McLean's concerns about disability, cognitive impairment, legal access and his ability to communicate with institutions.

The 3 March 2023 letter explicitly refers to a cognitive impairment that he attributes to his reported suicide attempt. The compilation also contains correspondence in which he challenges what he considers unfair treatment in administrative and tribunal processes.

These issues are relevant to whether a person can practically use complaint mechanisms, understand decisions, prepare evidence, meet deadlines and obtain appropriate assistance.

The presence of a disability does not automatically establish that an institution breached a duty. Equally, the existence of a formal process does not necessarily establish that a person had a meaningful opportunity to participate in it.

A careful review would ask:

- **Was the disability or impairment disclosed to the relevant decision-maker?**
- **Was the disclosure supported by medical evidence, and what did that evidence say?**
- **Were communication or participation difficulties raised at the time?**
- **Were any adjustments requested or offered?**
- **Were reasons for decisions supplied in an accessible and comprehensible form?**
- **Were review rights and deadlines explained?**
- **Was legal assistance available, and were any refusals documented?**

These are answerable questions. They are more useful than a general assertion that the entire system either helped or persecuted McLean.

10. The reported loss of work, security and ordinary life

The compilation describes McLean's belief that he lost income, possessions, housing security, insurance opportunities and access to assistance. It records his distress about the scale of those losses and his fear that his circumstances would continue to deteriorate.

Such testimony should be treated as evidence of what he reported and how he understood his situation. The amount of any financial loss, the cause of that loss and the responsibility of any particular person or institution require additional evidence.

A financial assessment would need to distinguish:

- **income actually earned before and after the relevant events;**
- **employment and contractual records;**
- **compensation claims and decisions;**
- **insurance policies, exclusions, claim decisions and appeal outcomes;**
- **documented expenses and debts;**
- **assets or possessions allegedly lost;**
- **benefits or supports approved, paid, withheld or refused; and**
- **losses that can be causally connected to a particular act or decision.**

The archive can help locate the relevant records. It should not replace that assessment with an aggregate figure unsupported by an itemised calculation.

The same principle applies to housing and personal safety. A dated request, a safety assessment, a refusal letter and a later accommodation outcome may together establish a meaningful chronology. Their precise implications depend on the wording, dates, responsibilities and outcomes recorded in the underlying documents.

11. Why the official register matters

A collection of correspondence can be difficult to assess when the reader cannot identify which document is authoritative, which version is complete, what happened next or whether a claim is being repeated from one document into another.

The Official Government Documents Register is intended to make the record navigable by identifying documents and their administrative context.

Entries such as OGDR-007, OGDR-027, OGDR-030, OGDR-036, OGDR-070 and OGDR-077 provide a starting point for tracing the chronology. Each should be opened and read in full before a conclusion is drawn about its legal or factual effect.

The register's function is not to declare every allegation proven. Its value is that it can link a claim to an identifiable source, a date, an institution and a particular outcome.

A robust evidence system should make it possible to move through the following chain:

Claim → contemporaneous communication → institutional response → decision or outcome → practical consequence → corroborating or contradictory evidence → unresolved question.

Where possible, every substantive claim should identify the source document, date, page or paragraph, and the exact passage supporting it.

Where an item is a personal statement, it should be labelled as testimony. Where it is an administrative decision, the decision-maker and scope should be identified. Where a conclusion is inferential, the reasoning and remaining uncertainty should be made explicit.

That structure permits independent verification and makes corrections possible without erasing the original record.

12. The digital archive: preservation is not the same as proof

McLean has established public repositories to preserve his documentary, autobiographical, evidentiary and religious writings.

The archive is unusual in the way it brings together official records, personal correspondence, chronology, analysis and a large body of authored material. Its value depends on whether a reader can navigate from the narrative to the primary evidence and assess the relationship between them.

Digital preservation can help demonstrate that a particular file existed in a particular form at a particular point in a documented process, especially where hashes, timestamps, repository histories and original copies are preserved appropriately.

But a cryptographic hash does not prove that the contents of a document are true. A timestamp does not independently validate the allegations within it. A repository commit does not prove that an event described in a file occurred. Preservation supports provenance and integrity; it does not replace substantive corroboration.

The archive should therefore preserve original files, record their provenance, distinguish originals from transcriptions or edited copies, and avoid implying that a later version has the same hash as an earlier version unless the bytes are identical.

These principles strengthen the archive. They make it easier for readers to check what a document is, when it was recorded and whether it has changed, while keeping the factual assessment separate.

13. The spiritual and prophetic writings

The Barran Dodger archive also includes gospels, prophetic papers, declarations, theological reflections and writings about survival, justice and divine purpose.

McLean presents his faith as central to his identity and as a source of meaning in circumstances he describes as profoundly distressing. His religious writing is part of the public record he has chosen to preserve.

The spiritual material and the administrative documents serve different purposes. A gospel or prophecy can communicate the author's convictions, moral framework and interpretation of survival. It does not independently establish that a named institution committed a particular act. An administrative letter can establish what an agency communicated, but it cannot determine the theological meaning the author assigns to his experience.

Both can be presented honestly without making one a substitute for the other.

For a public-interest investigation, this distinction matters. Readers should be able to understand the author's faith and moral argument while still being able to verify factual claims against the relevant records.

The archive's strongest principle is that readers should not be asked to accept a conclusion solely because the author believes it. They should be given enough source information to examine the evidence themselves.

14. What makes this record potentially significant to the public interest?

The public-interest value of this material lies in several connected features.

A longitudinal record

The archive spans multiple years and includes decisions, complaints and correspondence from several institutions. A longitudinal record can reveal the sequence of events and the practical consequences that are difficult to see in an isolated letter.

A record of attempted remedies

The documents do not consist solely of allegations about what happened. They also record attempts to obtain responses, invoke complaint processes, seek reviews and pursue support.

That makes it possible to investigate not only the original allegations but also how available remedies functioned in practice.

The distinction between procedure and substance

The Federal Court PID assessment is a useful example. It records an initial approach to the question of disclosable conduct while also identifying procedural or jurisdictional reasons the matter would not proceed through that process.

A reader can examine the difference between a decision about the route available to a complaint and a determination of the underlying facts.

The cumulative impact of administration

The archive raises a legitimate research question about how compensation, insurance, disability support, housing, legal access and complaints processes can interact in a vulnerable person's life.

The answer requires evidence, but the question is not limited to one institution or one decision.

The possibility of independent verification

The public repositories and document register create a route for independent readers to locate the materials, compare the narrative with primary records and identify where additional evidence is needed.

That is a meaningful contribution when the archive is properly indexed and the limits of each source are made clear.

15. What an independent reviewer should examine next

The most productive review would not begin by assuming either that the entire account is true or that it is false. It would start with a defined set of documentary questions.

First: reconstruct the chronology. Establish the dates of the alleged events, complaints, referrals, decisions, reviews and accommodation changes. Preserve the original dates and distinguish contemporaneous records from later recollections.

Second: examine the 3 March 2023 letter and its attachments. Identify what was sent, to whom it was sent, what evidence accompanied it, whether receipt was acknowledged and what response followed.

Third: examine the PID assessment and the related disclosure history. Read the full reasons for non-allocation and compare them with the correspondence that preceded

and followed the assessment. Identify any alternative referral or review pathway that was communicated.

Fourth: review compensation and insurance decisions separately. For each decision, identify the governing policy or legislation, the question actually decided, the evidence considered, the reasons given and the available review mechanism.

Fifth: verify the reported loss of possessions and housing instability. Locate any police, hospital, tenancy, property-removal, disposal, shelter or witness records that can corroborate or contradict the account.

Sixth: assess disability-related access. Determine what information about impairment or support needs was available to each relevant decision-maker and whether any requested adjustments were considered.

Seventh: itemise material losses. Separate verified financial amounts from estimates, disputed claims and losses that require proof of causation.

Eighth: test any claim of coordination. Identify evidence of communication, instruction, agreement or common purpose rather than inferring coordination solely from the fact that several institutions were involved.

Ninth: record the limits of the evidence. Where a document is missing, incomplete, unreadable or ambiguous, state that explicitly. Absence of a record is not automatically proof that an event did not occur, but neither is it proof that the event occurred.

Tenth: give the relevant parties a fair opportunity to respond. Where publication makes serious allegations about identifiable people or organisations, seek a response to the specific evidence and record that response accurately.

This method would produce an investigation that is more useful to the public, more defensible in its claims and more likely to identify the questions that genuinely need resolution.

16. The responsibility of public institutions

Public institutions have distinct statutory powers, eligibility rules and jurisdictional limits. They cannot all be expected to resolve every dispute placed before them.

However, where a person raises serious concerns, the public interest includes understanding how the matter was assessed, why a particular pathway was unavailable,

whether the person was directed to an appropriate alternative and whether the decision was explained clearly enough to be challenged or understood.

That does not mean that every complaint must be accepted, every requested benefit paid or every allegation investigated by every organisation. It means that administrative decisions should be capable of being understood and evaluated against the relevant rules and evidence.

The documents in this archive provide opportunities to examine those issues in specific instances.

The Federal Court PID assessment, the Ombudsman-related records, the Comcare and AAT material, the insurance correspondence and the later disability-support and accommodation records should each be considered on their own terms. The broader question is whether their combined effects reveal gaps in practical access to remedies or support that warrant further scrutiny.

That is a legitimate subject for public-interest reporting.

17. The ethical obligation of the reader

The archive is written by a person who describes himself as having endured severe harm and prolonged exclusion. Its language is sometimes urgent, accusatory, religious and absolute.

An ethical reader should neither adopt every conclusion uncritically nor use the tone of the writing as a substitute for examining the documents.

Distress does not itself prove an allegation. Unconventional beliefs do not automatically disprove a documentary claim. A formal decision does not necessarily settle questions outside the decision's scope. A large archive does not establish the truth of every item it contains.

The appropriate response is disciplined attention.

Read the letter. Read the response. Check the date. Identify the decision-maker. Follow the source link. Determine what was actually decided. Look for corroboration. Record what remains unknown.

Where the evidence supports a finding, state it clearly. Where it supports only a report or allegation, label it accurately. Where there is a reasonable question but insufficient

evidence to answer it, preserve the question without turning it into a verdict.

That is how the record can be taken seriously without overstating what it proves.

18. Conclusion: the record remains open to examination

Barran Dodger's archive presents a substantial first-person documentary project concerning his experiences across Australian public institutions and related administrative systems.

The supplied compilation records his 3 March 2023 communication to the CEO and Principal Registrar of the Federal Court, including allegations of serious harm, loss of possessions, homelessness and unsuccessful attempts to obtain protection or redress. It also contains correspondence concerning insurance, public-interest disclosures and other administrative matters.

The Official Government Documents Register identifies additional records spanning compensation, integrity complaints, disclosure assessment, tribunal proceedings, freedom of information, disability support, guardianship and accommodation.

Taken together, these materials provide a basis for a serious documentary investigation into the relationship between individual decisions, procedural barriers, material hardship and the practical availability of remedies.

They do not, without further examination, establish that all allegations are true, that every named party acted improperly or that a coordinated unlawful plan existed. They do establish a documentary trail of complaints, responses and decisions that can be checked and assessed.

The public-interest case is therefore strongest when framed as an invitation to investigate rather than a demand to accept a verdict in advance.

The question is whether the records, read in full and in context, reveal failures or gaps that deserve independent scrutiny—and what can be established about responsibility, consequences and appropriate redress.

McLean has chosen to preserve the record and make it publicly accessible. The next step for any independent reviewer is to examine the underlying documents, distinguish evidence from interpretation and follow the questions wherever the records lead.

The witness remains. The documents remain. The responsibility to examine them

carefully remains with every reader who chooses to engage with the record.

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Primary sources and documentary trail

The links below are intended to take readers to the archive and the underlying records. The repository contents should be checked directly before making a claim about the completeness or current availability of any file.

1. **Barran Dodger — main public archive**
   https://wezzo72.github.io/Barrandodger/
1. **Barran Dodger — GitHub repository**
   https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger
1. **Barran Dodger — rebuild archive**
   https://wezzo72.github.io/barrandodger-rebuild/
1. **Barran Dodger — rebuild GitHub repository**
   https://github.com/wezzo72/barrandodger-rebuild
1. **Dr Barran Dodger — archive repository**
   https://drbarrandodger.github.io/barran-dodger-archive/
1. **Official Government Documents Register**
   https://wezzo72.github.io/Barrandodger/official-government-documents-register.html
1. **Video forensic analysis page**
   https://barrandodger.com/video-forensic-analysis
1. **Related Church of Barran Dodger repository**
   https://github.com/wezzo72/-church-of-barran-dodger
1. **Related backup archive**
   https://wezzo72.github.io/Backup/

Priority document references

- **OGDR-007: Comcare determination, claim 1326583/1, 26 May 2021.**
- **OGDR-027: IBAC assessment outcome, 12 April 2022.**
- **OGDR-030: Commonwealth Ombudsman decision not to allocate a disclosure, 16 September 2022.**
- **OGDR-036: Federal Court PID assessment, 27 March 2023.**
- **OGDR-070: *Re Richard McLean and Comcare*, AAT decision, 12 July 2023.**
- **OGDR-077: NCAT Guardianship Division cover letter, 18 March 2026, concerning reasons in case 2024/00324093.**
- **3 March 2023: Letter from Dr Richard McLean to the CEO and Principal Registrar of the Federal Court, Sia Lagos, reproduced in *Dear The CEO and Principal Registrar of the Federal Court, Sia Lagos, at email a.pdf*.**

- **7 June 2022: HCF Life correspondence maintaining its decision to decline the Income Assist claim, reproduced in the same compilation.**

Editorial and evidentiary note

This article is a documentary narrative based on the identified source material and the register entries described above. It is not a substitute for reading the full source documents. The GitHub repository and its linked files should be checked for the exact current paths, page references and complete versions before publication.

Allegations concerning identifiable individuals or organisations should be presented as allegations unless independently established. Any subsequent correction, response, contrary evidence or final determination should be added to the record without silently altering the original source material.

The purpose is not to pre-judge the evidence. It is to make the evidence traceable, the questions precise and independent scrutiny possible.

Important limitation: I was able to retrieve relevant sections of the supplied PDF and the existing The Witness Remains article, and I used those to rebuild the narrative and incorporate specific document references. I could not independently verify every PDF or every current file path across the GitHub repository from the live web search in this turn, so I have not claimed that every repository file has been exhaustively scanned. The article is drafted to be evidence-led and publication-ready in structure, with allegations distinguished from established administrative outcomes.